Document Description Form

As of Oct 7, 2026

Fill in one copy of this form for each document (one letter, one program, one paper) and place it in front of the photographs as a cover page. Type your answers in the "Your entry" column. The last column shows where the information goes in the TEI header; you can ignore it.

How to fill in this form

- **Everyone fills in part A.** Then fill in only the one part (B, C or D) that matches the document type.
- **Required fields are in bold.** Fill as many others as time allows but make sure those are complete
- **Empty is fine.** Leave a field blank if it does not apply or you do not know.
- **Dates:** write YYYY-MM-DD, YYYY-MM or YYYY. For a range write 1962-03/1962-05.
- **Inferred information:** put anything that is not written on the document itself in [square brackets]. Add a question mark if you are unsure, for example [1962-03?].
- **Persons:** write Surname, Forename. Add a GND, VIAF or Wikidata ID if you know it.
- **Titles:** copy titles exactly as they appear, including spelling mistakes.

A. All documents

In the TEI column, `msDesc/` is short for `fileDesc/sourceDesc/msDesc/`. All paths start inside `teiHeader`.

A1. Identification

Field	What to enter	Your entry	TEI path
Document ID	Your own running number, e.g. NL-Meyer-0042	TEST-0001	`fileDesc/publicationStmt/idno`
Document type	One of: letter, postcard, telegram, conference program, manuscript of paper or talk, printed paper or offprint, notes, other (say what)	letter	`profileDesc/textClass/catRef/@target`
Title of document	Only if the document has one; copy it exactly, leave empty if no title		`fileDesc/titleStmt/title`
Descriptive title	Only if there is no title; e.g. "Letter from A to B, 12 March 1962"	Letter from Teszt Elek to Jane Example, 12 March 1962	`fileDesc/titleStmt/title[@type="supplied"]`
Author(s)	Person(s) who wrote or created the document, or “Unknown”	Teszt, Elek	`fileDesc/titleStmt/author` and `msDesc/msContents/msItem/author`

Field	What to enter	Your entry	TEI path
Corporate author	Institution, society or committee, if the author is not a person		`fileDesc/titleStmt/author/orgName`

A2. Where the original is kept

Field	What to enter	Your entry	TEI path
Country	Country of the holding institution	Hungary	`msDesc/msIdentifier/country`
City	City of the holding institution	Budapest	`msDesc/msIdentifier/settlement`
Holding institution	Archive, library or private owner	Example Archive	`msDesc/msIdentifier/repository`
Estate or collection	Name as used by the holder, e.g. "Nachlass Meyer"	Nachlass Example	`msDesc/msIdentifier/collection`
Shelfmark	Box, folder and item number, as used by the holder	Box 3, Folder 12, No. 4	`msDesc/msIdentifier/idno`

A3. Date and place of creation

Field	What to enter	Your entry	TEI path
Date	When the document was written or produced	1962-03-12	`msDesc/history/origin/origDate (@when, or @notBefore and @notAfter)`
Source of the date	One of: on the document, postmark, inferred from content, other (say what)	on the document	`msDesc/history/origin/origDate/@evidence`
Place	Where the document was written or produced or “unknown”	Budapest	`msDesc/history/origin/origPlace`

A4. Physical description

Field	What to enter	Your entry	TEI path
Extent	Number of leaves and written pages, e.g. "2 leaves, 3 pages written"	1 leaf, 2 pages written	`msDesc/physDesc/objectDesc/supportDesc/extent`

Field	What to enter	Your entry	TEI path
Material and format	E.g. letter paper, postcard, printed brochure; give the size if unusual	letter paper	`msDesc/physDesc/objectDesc/supportDesc/support`
Original or copy	One of: original, carbon copy, photocopy, draft, transcript by someone else	original	`msDesc/physDesc/objectDesc/@form`
Writing	One of: handwritten, typewritten, printed, mixed	handwritten	`msDesc/physDesc/handDesc/handNote` or `msDesc/physDesc/typeDesc/typeNote`
Letterhead, stamps, seals	Short description		`msDesc/physDesc/additions`
Later additions	Handwritten notes, underlinings or marginalia added later, and by whom if known		`msDesc/physDesc/additions`; one `handDesc/handNote` per further hand
Damage	Tears, fading, missing pages, loss of text	small tear at the upper margin	`msDesc/physDesc/objectDesc/supportDesc/condition`
Enclosures	Envelope, clippings, photographs. Say whether they are photographed here or as a separate document (give its ID)		`msDesc/physDesc/accMat`

A5. Content

Field	What to enter	Your entry	TEI path
Language(s)	All languages used in the document	hu; en	`profileDesc/langUsage/language/@ident`
Summary	Two to four sentences: what is the document about?	Thanks the addressee for an offprint and proposes a meeting at the conference in Vienna.	`profileDesc/abstract`
Keywords	Three to six topics, separated by semicolons	comparative law; conference; offprint	`profileDesc/textClass/keywords/term`

Field	What to enter	Your entry	TEI path
Names mentioned	Persons, institutions and events an annotator should recognise	Example, Jane; University of Vienna	`fileDesc/notesStmt/note[@type="entities"]`
Related documents	E.g. "reply to no. 0041", "draft of no. 0050"	reply to no. TEST-0000	`fileDesc/notesStmt/relatedItem` and `msDesc/additional/listBibl`

A6. Rights and sensitivity

Field	What to enter	Your entry	TEI path
May it be published?	Yes, no or unclear	unclear	`fileDesc/publicationStmt/availability/@status`
Reason for any restriction	E.g. author still in copyright, living persons mentioned, private content, condition set by the archive	author still in copyright	`fileDesc/publicationStmt/availability/p`
Rights holder	Heirs, archive or publisher, if known		`fileDesc/publicationStmt/availability/licence`

A7. Images and responsibility

Field	What to enter	Your entry	TEI path
Image files	File names in reading order with the page or side, e.g. IMG_0231 = 1r	IMG_0001 = 1r; IMG_0002 = 1v	`Outside the header: facsimile/surface/graphic/@url`
Pages not photographed	Blank or missing pages, if any		`msDesc/physDesc/objectDesc/supportDesc/foliation`
Photographed by	Name and date	Tester, Tom, 2026-10-01	`fileDesc/titleStmt/respStmt (resp: photography)`
Form filled in by	Name and date	Tester, Tom, 2026-10-02	`fileDesc/titleStmt/respStmt (resp: metadata)` and `revisionDesc/change`
Other remarks	Anything else worth noting		`fileDesc/notesStmt/note`

B. Letters, postcards and telegrams only

In the TEI column, `correspDesc/` is short for `profileDesc/correspDesc/`.

Field	What to enter	Your entry	TEI path
Sender(s)	Person or institution that sent the letter	Teszt, Elek	`correspDesc/ correspAction[@type="sent"]/persName or orgName`
Place of sending	As given in the letter or on the postmark	Budapest	`correspDesc/ correspAction[@type="sent"]/placeName`
Date of sending	As given in the letter or on the postmark	[1962-03-12?]	`correspDesc/ correspAction[@type="sent"]/date/@when`
Addressee(s)	Person or institution the letter is addressed to	Example, Jane	`correspDesc/ correspAction[@type="received"]/persName or orgName`
Place of receipt	Address the letter was sent to	Vienna	`correspDesc/ correspAction[@type="received"]/placeName`
Date of receipt	Only if noted, e.g. by a receipt stamp		`correspDesc/ correspAction[@type="received"]/date/@when`
Answers which letter?	ID or description of the earlier letter		`correspDesc/ correspContext/ ref[@type="replyTo"]`
Answered by which letter?	ID or description of the later letter		`correspDesc/ correspContext/ ref[@type="repliedBy"]`
Written on behalf of someone?	Name of the secretary or other person who wrote it, if not the sender		`correspDesc/ correspAction[@type="sent"]/ persName[@role="scribe"]`

C. Conference programs and other printed matter only

In the TEI column, `biblStruct/` is short for `fileDesc/sourceDesc/biblStruct/`.

Field	What to enter	Your entry	TEI path
Name of the event	Conference, congress, workshop or lecture series		`biblStruct/monogr/ meeting`
Date(s) of the event	First and last day		`biblStruct/monogr/ meeting/date`
Place of the event	City and venue		`biblStruct/monogr/ meeting/placeName`

Field	What to enter	Your entry	TEI path
Organiser(s)	Society, institute or persons		`biblStruct/monogr/respStmt (resp: organiser)`
Publisher or printer	Name and place, if printed		`biblStruct/monogr/imprint/publisher and pubPlace`
Role of the estate's creator	One of: speaker, chair, organiser, participant, unknown		`fileDesc/notesStmt/note[@type="participation"]`

D. Papers, talks and manuscripts only

Field	What to enter	Your entry	TEI path
Stage of the text	One of: notes, draft, fair copy, version sent for publication, printed offprint		`msDesc/msContents/msItem/note[@type="stage"]`
Occasion	Conference, lecture series or journal it was written for		`profileDesc/creation`
Later published?	Full reference, if known		`msDesc/additional/listBibl/bibl`
Differs from the published version?	One of: unknown, minor differences, substantial differences		`msDesc/additional/listBibl/bibl/note`

Budapest, 1962. márc. 12.

Kedves Jane!

Köszönöm a különlenyomatot,

nagy örömmel olvastam.

Remélem, Bécsben találkozunk

a konferencián.

Szívélyes üdvözlettel

Teszt Elek